



Crop: Hot pepper (*Capsicum frutescens*) – EPPO Code: CPSFR

Pathogen: *Fusarium oxysporum* f. sp. *Capsica* (*Pepper wilt*) - EPPO Code: FUSAOX

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Suggested control Measures:

Causal agent:

Fusarium oxysporum f. sp. *Lycopersici*, but also other fungi including *Verticillium dahlia* and bacteria

Symptoms:

Yellowing, inward rolling, and dropping of leaves. Stunted plants with small and yellowish leaves. Yellowing and wilting of the entire plant. Dark red and brown discoloration of vascular tissue. Eventually leaves dry, fruits shrivel and the plant dies.

Management practices - Good agricultural practices:

- Plant disease-free and certified seeds and seedlings
- Sanitation of fields and agricultural tools/equipment
- Growing pepper on well-drained soils
- Three to five years of crop rotation
- Avoid excessive nitrogen use
- Amendments of acidic soils to increase pH to 7
- Use resistant varieties (when available)
- Biological control with useful organisms like *Trichoderma* spp.
- Fungicides: Seed treatment with apronstar may provide some protection

Integrating more than one of the above-mentioned options may provide effective, economical and sustainable pepper wilt management

